Howbridge Infant School



Geography Policy

2025-26

Date last reviewed by Governing Body: November 2025

The Howbridge Infant School

POLICY NAME Geography Policy DATE OF REVIEW: November 2025

Aims and priorities for subject teaching and learning

Our school aim is to inspire children to enquire and investigate the world around them. To know key features of our local area (environment) and the wider world and be able to make comparisons. To develop an awareness of their impact on the environment and how we can work together to protect the world around us. Our curriculum will provide children with opportunities to work progressively throughout their time at Howbridge infant school, whilst also looking at a whole school vision and planning for special days linked to local, national and global learning.

Sources used for the scheme of work

In the foundation stage teaching activities and learning objectives are taken from **the Early Years Foundation Stage curriculum**.
The key intention of the Early Years Foundation Stage Curriculum is to develop in children a keen interest in and desire to learn about the world in which they live.

In Understanding of the World key concepts to be promoted are:

- To talk about the features of their own immediate environment and how environments might vary from one another
- To look closely at similarities, differences, patterns and change
- To use information and communications technology to support their learning.

The Early Years Foundation Stage is underpinned by the principle that young children learn best through self-initiated and supported play. It advocates a holistic approach to teaching and learning.
The key intention of the Early Years Foundation Stage Curriculum is to develop in children a keen interest in and desire to learn about the world in which they live.
Planning will be taken from the Early Adopter Early Learning Goals:

People, cultures and communities:

- Describe their immediate environment using knowledge from observation, discussion, stories, non-fiction texts and maps.
- Know some similarities and differences between different religious and cultural communities in this country, drawing on their experiences and what has been read in

class.

- Explain some similarities and differences between life in this country and life in other countries (drawing on knowledge from stories, non-fiction texts and maps)
- Explore the natural world around them, making observations and drawing pictures of animals and plants.
- Know some similarities and differences between the natural world around them and contrasting environments, drawing on their experiences and what has been read in class.
- Understand some important processes and changes in the natural world around them, including the seasons and changing states of matter.

Year 1 and 2 teaching is based on **The 2014 National Curriculum for Geography.**
Planning progression is planned within the Curriculum Foundation Subject map.
In KS1 children will learn

<u>Locational Knowledge</u>-

- To name and locate the world's seven continents and five oceans.
- To name, locate and identify the countries and capital cities of the United Kingdom. This will enable children to identify their own town and our position in relation to the rest of the UK.

<u>Place Knowledge</u>

- To understand geographical similarities and differences, both human and physical geography. Children will be able to make comparisons between their own environment and those of other places in the U.K and other areas of the world.
- To contrast an area of the United Kingdom with a non-European country

<u>Human and Physical Geography</u>

- To observe weather patterns and seasons in the UK and locate hot and cold areas of the world in relation to the Equator, the North and South Poles.
- Children will be able to make comparisons between different parts of the world. This will be linked to the Globals Goals work enabling children to understand their own impact on the local environment and in the wider world.
- To use key physical and human geographical vocabulary

<u>Development of geographical skills and fieldwork.</u>

- To use maps, globes and atlases to identify the UK and its countries, as well as other countries, continents and oceans. Access to a variety of maps and atlases will enable the children to use these confidently to identify different parts of the world, giving the opportunity to develop a greater understanding of their local environment and the wider world.

- To know simple compass directions and be able to use directional language.
- To be able to describe a location, its features and routes on a map. Children will be able to use appropriate vocabulary to describe different locations, and to ask appropriate questions to further their knowledge and understanding.
- To use aerial photographs and plans to recognise landmarks and basic human and physical features.
- To devise a simple map using basic symbols in a key. This will enable the children to demonstrate their understanding of the different features and human uses within their immediate environment.
- To use simple fieldwork and observational skills to study the geography of their school and its grounds and key human and physical features of its surrounding environment. The children will have greater awareness of how these are interrelated, and their own impact upon them.

School trips/local walks/walks around school grounds organised throughout the year, may have a geography focus or have opportunities to explore geographical topics and themes.

Strategies for teaching

Teaching varies according to the needs of the class and the nature of what is being taught. Whole class, group and individual teaching are used in a variety of activities. Practical and first hand experiences are included whenever possible, including visits. (e.g. school environment, local park, seaside) and visitors (parents from other countries).

In year 1 and 2 geography is taught as part of a cross curricular topic, during theme weeks (Global goals week), special occasions (e.g. Olympics, Football World Cup) and as opportunities arise (natural disasters worldwide e.g. floods, volcano eruptions, earthquakes). British Values assemblies and lesson planning will also focus on aspects of Geography related to The United Kingdom.

Planning includes opportunities to revisit previous knowledge and skills taught.

Planning, marking and feedback

Long, medium and short term plans are based on the National Curriculum. These plans may be amended following discussions with year group teachers to suit the needs of the cohort. Differentiation of activities and outcomes are planned as well as opportunities for children to work at greater depth. Marking is formative and summative and through verbal feedback.

Assessment, recording and reporting

Assessment will be made in accordance with the End of Key Stage Descriptions in the National Curriculum. Children will be observed throughout geography lessons as part of their assessment. Photographs or whole class floor books may also be used to record activities and progress. Opportunities to develop their understanding further, through mastery opportunities should be given to those children working above the expected level. The member of staff responsible for the subject reviews the class teacher assessments. Teacher assessments to be recorded on our school assessment tool sonar.
Photographic evidence to show activities children have been doing. In year 1 and 2 the children's work is recorded in floor books and topic books and in the foundation stage it can be recorded in floor books and Tapestry observations. Parents have access to pupils' work at school events such as open mornings and consultation sessions. Comments relating to geography could be included within the annual report to parents.

Inclusion - equal opportunities, racial awareness, gender, more able, SEN

We aim to set suitable learning targets, respond to pupils' diverse needs and overcome potential barriers to learning and assessment for groups and individuals and follow the guidance set out in The National Curriculum Handbook, key stage 1 and 2. The children's entitlement is based upon the programmes of study as defined in the Statutory Orders. All children regardless of race, gender and ability, will be given equal access to geography. Classroom management takes account of such issues and classroom materials free from bias will be positively sought.

Resource use, monitoring and acquisition

Most resources are held centrally and organised by theme; some are held within year groups. Resources are reviewed annually and matched to these units. Year team leaders identify other resource needs from planning. The use of maps and the internet are used to support the children's learning and understanding. To keep up to date with whole school planning to ensure progression across the year groups.

Links with other subjects

Through the cross-curriculum topic approach, links are made to other subjects, in particular: Literacy, Maths, Art, History and Computing.

Monitoring and evaluation of teaching and learning

Curriculum delivery will be regularly monitored by looking at year group planning, samples of work, discussions with children and looking at classroom displays. A subject review is

carried out by the subject leader and shared within a staff meeting.
Staff and school development
The focus for staff development links to the school improvement and subject development plans and takes into account individual needs identified through performance management.
Review
This policy will be reviewed annually as part of the subject development programme. It will be re-drafted periodically as necessary taking account of the school's development plan and new local and national curriculum requirements